DDA5001 Workstation Quick Guide

Classroom use

1. Start and sign in

Use the workstation in your confirmed booking in **Zhixin Building 208**. If it is powered off, turn it on and choose **Ubuntu**. If Windows 11 is running, restart and choose Ubuntu at the operating-system menu. **Do not use Windows 11 for these experiments: the course environment is not installed there and training may fail.**

Sign in as **`user1` for a morning booking** or **`user2` for an afternoon booking**. The initial workstation password is `DDA5001-2026`. The booking website uses your student ID and a separate password.

For this visit, change the shared initial Linux password to a temporary group password using `passwd` in Terminal, and tell your teammate. Nothing appears while typing passwords. This protects your session even though the password resets after reboot.

2. Open your code and work

Your project files are ready in `~/work/project1`. The desktop **Project 1** folder links to it. In VS Code, choose **File** → **Open Folder**, select this folder, then **Terminal** → **New Terminal**. The course Python environment is selected automatically; no initialization or environment installation is needed.

Each workstation has **one RTX 5090D GPU with 24 GB of VRAM** and the course Python/PyTorch environment. Follow the code README and project handbook for tasks and commands. Run **one training job at a time**. The prepared dataset is shared read-only; edit your own code and save results in your home directory.

3. Coding agents

The **TUI versions of Codex and OpenCode** are prepared. Run `codex` or `opencode` in your project terminal and use your own service account. If you prefer another agent or interface, arrange its setup yourself.

4. Back up before leaving or rebooting

The Lenovo-managed system restores its initial image on reboot, **including your home directory, changed Linux password and login state**. Local code and results will be lost. Back up to your own external storage or private repository and verify the copy **before** leaving or rebooting. After a reboot, you start from the initial template again.

The project's result-export ZIP excludes checkpoints and the supplied dataset. Back up required `.pt` files separately if you need them later. Allow time for large transfers and watch your disk quota. Before your slot ends, stop your jobs, sign out of personal services and log out of Ubuntu.

5. Access and help

Workstations are for **on-site use only**; student SSH access is disabled. Do not use another group's account. If code, software or login does not work, contact the TA with the machine number, username and exact error. Do not send passwords or keys.

If your whole group cannot attend, arrange your own GPU resources in advance. Kaggle is one possible option; availability, quotas and speed vary. Use the released code's `p1/setup/README.md` for personal setup. Project requirements and submission rules follow the **project handbook**.

Booking: `http://10.20.34.22:8088/` Each confirmed session lasts five hours.